Mom's Hospital Papers, Dates and Contacts, in One Place

A one-page inventory of what you've been handed and told, and what you still need to ask for.

The medication list is in your bag, the social worker's card is in your coat pocket, and the date somebody mentioned is in a text to your brother.

This page doesn't ask you to understand any of it. It asks where each thing is, how recent it is, and who has it.

WHAT TO COLLECT	WHERE IT IS	ITS DATE	WHO HAS IT
The discharge plan or discharge papers, in writing			
Her diagnoses and the reason for this stay, as they were given to you			
The current medication list, and what changed during the stay			
The expected discharge date, and who told you			
Any other dates you've been given, and who gave each one			
Any letter or notice you've been handed about coverage or billing			
Mom's Medicare card and any other insurance cards			
The discharge planner or social worker: name and phone number			
The doctor, nurses and therapists involved: names and roles			
The business office: a name and phone number			
Who is making healthcare decisions with Mom or for her, and where any paperwork about that is kept			
Family members who can help: names, phone numbers, and the days they're free			

What's missing, and who will ask for it

Anything above with an empty line. Put a name next to each.

FOR EXAMPLE Nothing in writing about the discharge plan yet. The date we have came from a nurse in passing. Mark will ask the discharge planner on Thursday.

How to use it

- Write the date printed on each paper. If it has no date, write “undated” and ask for a current copy.
- For anything you were told and not handed, write who said it and on which day.
- Don't rewrite or summarize a document here. Just say where it is.
- Bring this page and the papers to the discharge conversation.

What this page doesn't do

It doesn't explain what any paper, notice or instruction means. If you read something you don't understand, that's a question for the person or office that gave it to you. Nothing here is medical, legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where each paper and phone number is, and which ones you still need to ask for. The care interview uses what you've collected: it walks you through Mom's situation area by area and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The first row follows the Family Caregiver Alliance's discharge guide, which tells families to ask for all instructions and guidance in writing. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's working list for this step.

1. Family Caregiver Alliance, Hospital Discharge Planning: A Guide for Families and Caregivers